STRIDE IISP 5.0

Artificial Intelligence – Acceptable Use Policy (AI-AUP)

Purpose

This policy governs the use of Artificial Intelligence Technology in Stride's diverse computing environments.

Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all Stride personnel, including employees, contractors, sub-contractors, and their respective facilities supporting Stride business operations, technology, or both, wherever Stride data is stored or processed, including any third-party contracted by Stride to handle, process, transmit, store, or dispose of Stride data.

Definitions

All definitions are located within the document Stride - ISP 1.2 – IT Policy Definitions.

Any inquiries regarding terminology or clarity may be directed to Stride's Information Security Team for assistance.

Publication Owners

Johnny Burns – Point of Contact, Content Coordinator & Author

Jen Havenner – Business Owner

Mark Williams – Executive Sponsor

Document Control

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This document will be reviewed at least annually and re-issued when revisions are necessary. Any changes introduced in the most recent version are itemized below. Obsolete copies should be destroyed or archived upon the release of the newest version.

Implementation and Compliance

All business units are required to comply with any changes applied to the most recent version of this publication within 90 days from the date of publication.

Change History

Version	Date of Change	Summary of Change(s)
.01	08/31/23	- Initial Release and Publication
.02	10/27/23	- Legal recommendations added
.03	11/15/23	- Published
1.0	2/24/25	- Updated Publication Owners, Change History, definitions reference - Added Document Control and Implementation and Compliance language - Changed policy numbering to align with PMC requirements

Introduction

Rapidly evolving Artificial Intelligence (AI) technology presents a significant risk to the organization's privacy, security, and reputation of Stride's business operations. In its current state, even unskilled users can utilize powerful AI engines to create malicious code, forge content through unethical means, and mimic identities.

This document provides language relevant to Stride's Leadership Team's efforts to create parameters for the Acceptable Use of AI Technology. All AI technology must be formally reviewed and approved as described in this document.

Classifications of Artificial Intelligence

This section classifies categories of Artificial Intelligence, which is subject to change as the field of Artificial Intelligence rapidly evolves. As of the date of publication, only two AI technologies currently exist at the consumer level, those are Reactive Machines and Limited Memory. Theory of Mind and Self-Aware AI technology is theoretical or prototype at present.

1. Reactive Machines

    a. The most basic type of artificial intelligence is reactive AI, which is programmed to provide a predictable output based on the input it receives.

2. Limited Memory

    a. Limited memory AI learns from the past and builds experiential knowledge by observing actions or data.

3. Theory of Mind

    a. Theory of mind level AI will be able to understand better the entities it is interacting with by discerning their needs, emotions, beliefs, and thought processes.

4. Self-Aware

    a. AI that has evolved to be so akin to the human brain that it has developed self-awareness.

Risk of Public AI

Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI or GAI) trains itself on user input, that input is sometimes utilized to create output using algorithms (machine learning). Confidential or personal data used as input on Generative AI Technology can present the risk of retaining that data and producing it as output for other users. Public AI is available to users throughout the world and may, at any time, reproduce data inputs as output. There is also an inherent risk of AI Technology falling victim to a cyberattack, exposing data in the AI's storage, including any confidential or personal data.

Acceptable Use

The use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) is further governed by this document, which supplements Stride's existing Acceptable Use Policy. Artificial Intelligence (AI) presents a unique risk to the organization due to the capabilities and current state of the technology. For additional information regarding general acceptable use requirements and restrictions, please reference Stride's Acceptable Use Policy, which can be located here or within the Employee Handbook.

Examples of Acceptable Use with a strong business use case are:

- For general-knowledge questions meant to enhance your understanding of a work-related topic.
- To brainstorm ideas related to projects you are working on.
- To create formulas for Excel spreadsheets or similar programs.
- To develop or debug code, to be verified before deployment.
- To draft an email or letter.
- To summarize online research or to create outlines for content projects to assist in full coverage of a topic. Only content written by employees may be included in a final product.

All use is subject to approval by Stride Leadership after a thorough risk assessment of the proposed use.

Prohibited Use

Stride's sector of business is especially sensitive in nature where student data and other personally identifiable data are concerned, therefore Stride has established a broad list of prohibited uses of AI technology. Prohibited use includes:

- All illegal activity is banned.

- Any use which violates Stride's observed regulations (i.e., SOX, FERPA, etc.) is banned.

- Any use that may expose or put at risk Stride's proprietary, confidential, or sensitive data is explicitly prohibited.

    - *This includes utilizing such data as input for Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI or GAI), chatbots, editing purposes, or any other utilization that requires the employee or user to submit data.*

- Users are prohibited from attempting to access, modify, or manipulate AI systems or data beyond their authorized privileges.

- AI technologies must not be used for malicious purposes, including but not limited to hacking, spreading malware, or conducting illegal activities.

- Users are prohibited from creating or deploying AI systems that intentionally deceive or mislead individuals, such as deepfake technologies used for fraudulent purposes.

- Failing to properly cite an AI chatbot when used as a resource is a violation of Acceptable Use and may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Responsibilities

Proper usage of Artificial Intelligence Technology includes various responsibilities which the user of the technology must observe. These responsibilities include, but are not limited to:

- Any content produced via Generative AI must be labeled or footnoted as containing Generative AI information by the Employee generating the content. Additionally, keeping inventory of AI generated content is essential in determining and protecting intellectual property rights of Stride's content.

- Employees must disclose the use of any Artificial Intelligence Technology that may process biometric data of other employees, customers, students, consumers, or any other individuals. This means disclosure (and in most instances consent) is needed prior to using Artificial Intelligence Technology that will collect, use, transmit, record, monitor, or otherwise process any audio, video, photos, behaviors, or similar data of any individuals.

- Employees must ensure that the appropriate privacy settings are in place with the use of any approved Artificial Intelligence Technology. Examples include opting-out of sharing output with other users and opting out of training an AI model with any data uploaded into the AI model.

- Users of AI tools are responsible for properly citing and reviewing all outputs formulated by an AI tool. Any output inclusive of the following data or information types must be appropriately cited:

    - Intellectual property or proprietary information
    - Personal information
    - Confidential or secret information
    - Licensed information
    - Trademarked or copyrighted information

- Employees will receive and complete training on AI ethics, responsible AI use, and the organization's policies related to AI technologies.

- Communication channels have been established to foster awareness of AI policies, updates, and best practices among employees and stakeholders. Employees must review any communications sent regarding AI and direct all questions to their management team for clarification.

Reporting Violations

Any suspected violation of the Artificial Intelligence – Acceptable Use Policy (AI-AUP) shall be reported by the party witnessing the violation to infosec@k12.com.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Request Format and Process

All requests for AI tools will be received through the AI Initiatives Intake Form located here: AI Initiatives Intake Form. The form must be filled out in its entirety before a request will be considered and reviewed by appropriate parties. The considerations below should be reviewed before requesting access to an AI tool.

Stride has limited the approved business uses of AI, the following is true as related to the usage of AI tools:

- Requests for the usage of Artificial Intelligence Technology will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis.

- A clear and valid business use case is required and must be included with any request submitted for review.

- Requests without a clear and valid use case will be denied by default.

- All requests will be recorded in Stride's ticketing system and reviewed by members of the Information Security Team.

- Additional review may be required if it is determined that the AI Technology presents risks or complexity requiring such review.

- All approved use of AI tools is ultimately subject to the discretion of Stride Leadership.

Risk Review and Approvals

Personnel will be designated to review requested access and usage of Artificial Intelligence which presents a clear and valid business use case. These personnel will be selected based on their knowledge and expertise in Stride's computing environment and the area in which the AI Technology will be implemented. Stride's Information Security Team will provide input and recommendations on proposed AI Technology. Upon review, the Information Security Team will determine any risk to the organization.

- If the determined risk is above acceptable thresholds the request will be denied with justification.

- If the determined risk is deemed to be within acceptable thresholds the request will proceed to final approval and implementation.

Approvals and denials are final and may only be overridden by a member of the Board of Executives with a signed waiver.

Procurement and Implementation

Various teams within Stride may be involved with the procurement and implementation of Artificial Intelligence technology.

Following the approval of Artificial Intelligence technology, a team will be assigned to procure and implement the technology into the appropriate operating environment. A

System Owner will be assigned to ensure the technology is supported, updated, and decommissioned when determined necessary.

Documentation and Inventory

At all times, an inventory will be maintained to appropriately document the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Technology that has been implemented within Stride's computing environments. The inventory where AI Technology is documented must be reviewed, at minimum, annually in accordance with Stride's Software Asset Management Standard.

The AI Inventory shall include, at minimum, the following information:

1. The name of the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Technology
2. Source and publisher of the AI Technology
3. Date of Implementation
4. Purpose describing the business use case
5. Last update or review date

Policy Enforcement

Any violation of this policy will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.